

Backup Plan

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Organization: NorthStar Logistics Ltd. (Simulation)

Document Type: Backup Plan

Date: June 2026

Company Scenario

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. is a logistics and supply chain company that manages customer deliveries, inventory, employee records, financial transactions, and operational data. The organization relies heavily on digital systems to support its daily business operations. To ensure business continuity and protect critical information from **Cyber attacks** hardware failures, accidental deletion, and natural disasters, the company requires a comprehensive backup strategy.

This backup plan outlines the procedures, backup responsibilities, storage methods, backup schedules, and data recovery approach that will help safeguard organizational data while minimizing downtime during security incidents or system failures.

Step 1

Backup Responsibility: IT Team

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. has assigned the **IT Team** the responsibility for managing the organization's backup operations.

The IT Team will configure, monitor, verify, and maintain the backup system to ensure that critical business data is backed up successfully and can be restored whenever necessary. Although backup software will automate the backup process, the IT Team will regularly review backup logs, perform

recovery tests, investigate backup failures, and ensure compliance with the organization's backup policies.

Assigning backup management to the IT Team provides greater accountability, reduces the risk of human error, and ensures that backup and recovery procedures are carried out consistently in accordance with industry best practices.

Step 2

Data Types to Be Backed Up

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. will back up the following categories of critical business data:

Data Type | Example

Employee Records | Employee payroll records and personnel files

Financial Records | Accounting records, invoices, and tax documents

Customer Data | Customer contact information and delivery records

Business Documentation | Company policies, operational procedures, and contracts

Intellectual Property | Proprietary logistics processes, strategic plans, and internal reports

System Data | Server configurations, operating system settings, application data, and system logs

Backing up these data types ensures that the organization can quickly recover critical information following **Cyber attacks**, hardware failures, accidental deletion, or natural disasters while maintaining business continuity.

Step 3

Daily Backup Type: Incremental Backup

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. will perform incremental backups on a daily basis.

An **incremental backup** copies only the data that has changed since the previous backup, making it the most efficient option for daily operations. Compared to full and differential backups, incremental backups require less storage space, consume fewer network resources, and complete more quickly, minimizing disruption to business activities.

Because NorthStar Logistics Ltd. processes large volumes of operational, customer, and financial data each day, incremental backups provide an effective balance between backup performance, storage efficiency, and recovery capability. To support complete data restoration, incremental backups will be combined with regularly scheduled full backups.

Step 4

Backup Storage Strategy – 3-2-1 Rule

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. will implement the 3-2-1 Backup Rule to improve data availability and resilience against **Cyber attacks**, hardware failures, and natural disasters.

The backup strategy will include:

- Three (3) copies of data

- One production copy.
- Two backup copies.

- **Two (2) different storage media**

- A Network Attached Storage (NAS) device located within the company's data center.
- Secure cloud backup storage provided by a trusted cloud service provider.

- **One (1) off-site backup**

- An encrypted cloud backup stored in a geographically separate location from the company's primary office.

Implementing the 3-2-1 Backup Rule ensures that data remains available even if one storage device fails, the primary office experiences a disaster, or ransomware compromises local systems. Using multiple storage locations significantly improves business continuity and disaster recovery capabilities.

Step 5

Backup Schedule

NorthStar Logistics Ltd. will implement a combination of daily and weekly backups to ensure efficient data protection and reliable disaster recovery.

- Daily incremental backups will be performed to capture all new and modified data generated during business operations. These backups minimize storage usage and reduce backup completion time.
- Weekly full backups will be conducted to create a complete copy of all organizational data. Full backups provide a reliable recovery point and simplify the restoration process when recovering from major system failures or cybersecurity incidents.

Combining daily incremental backups with weekly full backups provides an effective balance between storage efficiency, backup performance, and data recovery. This approach ensures that business-critical information remains protected while minimizing downtime and supporting the organization's business continuity objectives.

Conclusion

A well-designed backup strategy is essential for protecting organizational data and ensuring business continuity. By assigning backup responsibilities to the IT Team, safeguarding critical business information, implementing daily incremental and weekly full backups, and following the 3-2-1 Backup Rule, NorthStar Logistics Ltd. significantly reduces the risk of data loss resulting from **Cyber attacks**, hardware failures, human error, or natural disasters.

This backup plan establishes a reliable framework for data protection and disaster recovery while supporting the organization's operational resilience. Regular monitoring, periodic backup restoration testing, and continuous improvement of backup procedures will help ensure that critical business systems and information remain secure, available, and recoverable whenever needed.

